

THE ROLES OF A HUSBAND

The role of a husband is not just having authority, but it carries with it tremendous responsibilities. By God's plan, the husband is the head, the direction-giver and the decision-maker in the home. But just as satan has perverted the role of submission, so he has perverted the role of headship. The perverted attitude that has crept into the church is this: because the man is the head of the house, he can demand that his wife do anything that he says, and she can't say anything about it. You will not find that attitude in the Word of God.

Let's look at some scriptures and see what God has to say about the husband's role in the home. God has delegated authority to the man; therefore, you must remember that you have headship only because it's given by God, not because you've earned it or you're entitled to it. You must have an attitude of submission -- to God and His Word and to your wife as a joint-heir of God's grace and co-worker in God's kingdom.

Write out the following scripture:

Ephesians 5:21

1 Peter 3:7

Galatians 3:28

This submission does not mean that you give up your place of headship and authority. It means that you realise that what you have has been given to you by God, and you are in partnership with your wife to accomplish God's will for your lives and home.

Let's break down the roles of a husband and look at some individual areas. You will notice that in most of the scriptures, God will give you a directive, then follow it up with the responsibilities that go with it.

The first area we'll look at is 'headship'. When we think of the function of the head in relation to the body, we think of it giving us direction and making decisions.

Write out the following scriptures:

Ephesians 5:23

I Corinthians 11:3

Read 1 Corinthians 12:14-21

1. Why are you to be the head of your home?

2. Who is the example for you to follow?

3. Can you do this job by yourself, or do you have a body to work with and consider?

4. Ephesians 5:23 says that Christ is the head of the church. It also says He is the Savior of the body. What are your thoughts about being the saviour of your home and family? ('Saviour' in the Greek means: deliverer, protect, heal, preserve, do well, make whole.)

5. The head gives direction. Do you have a general direction for yourself, your future wife, your family, etc.? If so, write down what it is at this time. (Your direction will vary and/or become more specific through the years.)

6. The head makes decisions. How would you rate yourself in the area of decision-making on a scale of 1 – 5? 1 being that decision-making is easy and 5 being that it is very difficult. Explain your answer.

Evaluate yourself in the area of decision-making. Rate yourself on the following statements, using the first letter of the word.

ALWAYS

USUALLY

SOMETIMES

NEVER

1. I make decisions easily. _____
2. For major decisions, I seek advice. _____
3. I would rather let someone else make the decision. _____
4. I feel confident making decisions. _____
5. It's easier for me to make a decision for myself than when someone else is involved. _____
6. I have difficulty making decisions. _____
7. I tend to make a decision, then change my mind. _____
8. I do not make a decision without much prayer, consideration and counsel _____
9. I can make quality decisions under pressure. _____
10. I seek my wife's input on important decisions. _____

The next role that we need to consider is that of the 'provider. The head of the home is also the primary breadwinner. It is not wrong for the wife to work outside of the home, but it is not her responsibility to provide the financial stability for the home. She is a helpmate in the financial area but is not the primary provider.

1. Write out I Timothy 5:8

2. Are you presently employed?

3. If not, do you plan to wait until you are employed before you marry?

4. Is your future wife presently employed?

5. Will she continue to work after you are married?

6. Have you discussed how both of you feel about your future wife working?

What agreement did you reach?

Another role we will discuss is that of 'protector. You are to be a shield for your wife, family and home. Your future wife needs to have the security of knowing that when pressures are more than she can handle, you will step into the situation. As you better understand your future wife and learn her strengths and weaknesses, you will be able to take control of situations before they put pressure on her. The effectiveness of you being a protector starts in the spiritual realm.

Write out the following scriptures:

1. Ephesians 6:11,12

2. 2 Corinthians 10:3-5

3. Matthew 18:18

4. Do you pray for your future wife, your marriage, your future, etc.?

You must also be a protector, a buffer zone, for your future wife in the emotional realm.

1. What situations seem to cause her the most stress?

2. What ways can you help to relieve the stress?

3. Do you recognize when she needs encouragement? Do you give her encouragement? How do you encourage her?

4. Write out Philippians 2:3-4

5. Write out Romans 14:19

6. Write out I Thessalonians 5:15

One of the most important roles you have to carry out is that of loving your wife. This love for your wife is a blend of physical love, friendship love and God's love. It is a sacrificial love where you would hurt yourself before you would let her be hurt. It is an unselfish love that has no conditions or requirements.

1. Write out Ephesians 5:25-29

2. If you are to love your wife as Christ loved the church, then you must have some understanding of this relationship. In your opinion, what ways did Jesus demonstrate His love for the church?

3. How can you apply this to your future wife?

4. In your opinion, what does it mean to love your wife as your own body?

5. You are to nourish your wife. 'Nourish' means: to promote the growth of. How will you promote your future wife's spiritual, emotional, and intellectual growth?

6. You are to cherish your wife. 'Cherish' means: "to hold dear; feel or show affection for". In what ways will you show affection for your future wife?

7. Write out Colossians 3:19

8. Write out Proverbs 31:28-29

9. Write down the qualities that you find praiseworthy about your future wife.

10. Write a letter to her expressing your praise and appreciation for these qualities.

Loving, praising and appreciating your wife will keep you out of bitterness. Make a commitment, right now, that your speech will be edifying and minister grace to your wife. (Ephesians 4:29; Colossians 4:6) By the authority given to you by God, you are the leader in your home; by the grace of God, you will love your wife and enjoy God's blessings in your home.

Recommended Reading: Point Man by Steve Farrar

THE ROLES OF A WIFE

God created man and woman equal in His sight. We are not inferior or superior to each other. He assigned to the man and woman specific roles in the marriage relationship, and He gave them the ability and the grace to function in these roles.

As you prepare for marriage, you must have a clear understanding of your role in the marriage relationship according to God's Word. God gave the woman definite qualities and abilities to accomplish His purpose of being the only suitable helper for man. By God's design, the man is the head and direction-giver in the home. By that same design, the woman is the man's helper. A woman is to help, be a companion to, be an aid, and be alongside the man to assist him in his responsibilities.

According to the Word, a wife's primary responsibilities are to submit to and respect her husband. Don't cringe at the word 'submission' -- it's not a dirty word. Submission was God's idea; therefore, it is good because He gives only 'good and perfect gifts'. It's satan's perversion of submission that has made it distasteful to women. Everyone is submitted to someone or something. Even Jesus, who was equal with God, submitted Himself to God. When the Bible speaks of submission, it's talking about being in obedience - putting yourself in a position to obey a higher authority. For we as wives, biblical submission is a place of safety and security. But you will find it difficult to submit to your husband if you have not first submitted to God and His Word.

Let's look at some scriptures that will show what you are to be submitted to. Write out the following scriptures:

James 4:7

Romans 10:3

Ephesians 5:21 & 22

Submission to your husband is a fruit of your submission to the Word. You are not submitting to your husband because he is so wonderful and deserving; you do it as unto the Lord in obedience to the Word.

A word that goes hand-in-hand with submission is the word 'adapt'. I Peter 3:1, Ephesians 5:22, and Colossians 3:18, in the Amplified version, tells wives that they are to adapt themselves to their husbands. The definition of 'adapt' is: 'to make fit (as for a specific or new use or situation) often by modification. Adapt implies a modification according to changing circumstances. When you marry, your circumstances are going to undergo a dramatic change. Your life will need to be modified to adjust to your new husband.

You are probably in the habit of doing things a certain way - you have a routine for your life. Now is the time to adjust your thinking for the modifications that are going to come.

Answer the following questions:

How do you handle change? Is change easy or difficult for you? Do you accept change or try to avoid it? Are you quick to adapt, or do you need time to think and adjust?

Every area of your life will be affected by your marriage. There will be changes, to some degree, in every area. Take time now to think about some of these areas and the changes that will come. Write down what changes you think you'll have to make.

1. Finances: Will you have more or fewer responsibilities? Are you ready to merge your income? Who will handle the chequebook? Will you be on a budget, etc.?

2. Schedules: How will your schedule fit with your husband's? Does he work different shifts? How will you encourage quality time together, etc?

3. Socially: Will you be staying home more often than you like or going out more often than you like? Will you need to entertain guests? How often will you get together with your families; what about holidays, etc?

4. Spiritually: How will you maintain your personal quiet time? Are you comfortable with praying together? How often will you be attending church, etc?

5. Sexual Relationship: This will be worked out in greater detail after the marriage. Do you have any fears or anxieties? Are you looking forward to giving yourself to your husband? Do you have attitudes that need to change?

6. There are other areas to consider, such as communication, handling conflicts, daily routines, children, etc. Write down any thoughts you have about any other areas.

Now, let's look at our second area of responsibility, and that is respect. Ephesians 5:33, in the Amplified, says, *"and let the wife see that she respects and reverences her husband - that she notices him, regards him, honours him, prefers him, venerates and esteems him; and that she defers to him, praises him and loves and admires him exceedingly"*.

I Peter 3:2, in the Amplified, says, *"When they observe the pure and modest way in which you conduct yourselves, together with your reverence for your husband. That is, you are to feel for him all that reverence includes -- to respect, defer to, revere him; revere means to admire, praise, be devoted to, deeply love and enjoy your husband."* As you can see, respecting your husband includes many aspects.

1. Does the Word put conditions on respecting your husband? (i.e. "I'll respect him when ..." or "I'll respect him if ...") Please explain your answer:

2. Why are you to respect your husband?

3. The two scriptures that were given tell you many qualities that respect includes. Write down some practical ideas that will show how you will:

A. Notice him

B. Prefer him:

C. Honour him:

D. Enjoy him:

E. Praise him:

F. Admire him:

G. Devote yourself to him:

Another area to consider is that of being a helpmate. Genesis 2:18 says, *"And the Lord God said, 'It is not good that man should be alone; I will make him a helper comparable to him.'"* You are to be a helper to your husband -- not a mother who does everything for him, and not a boss who tells him what he should do. God has called you to be his helper, his assistant.

Write your thoughts about how you will help your husband in the following areas:

1. Emotionally:

2. Spiritually:

3. Socially:

4. Intellectually:

5. Career-wise:

6. Other areas:

The Word says that you are to be a friend to your husband. Titus 2:4 says, "*that they admonish the young women to love their husbands, to love their children,*". The type of love referred to in this scripture is a friendship love.

These are the characteristics that make up this type of love: being a friend, an ally, a supporter and a sympathiser. We can compile the definitions of all of these words into one definition that would say: "a wife is a friend who joins herself to her husband for a common purpose, to give him courage, faith, and approval and to understand his feelings and ideas and brings herself into harmony and accord with him according to God's will."

Friendship is a very important element in your marriage relationship. Let us see what Proverbs has to say about being a friend.

Write out the following scriptures:

1. Proverbs 17:17

2. Proverbs 18:24

3. Proverbs 27:9

4. Proverbs 27:17

Meditate on these scriptures and ask God to show you practical ways that you can apply them in your marriage.

If you desire to be a wife, then God's will for you is to be a helpmate to your husband, respecting him and being a friend to him.

Please remember this scripture that will act as a guideline for you in your marriage, Proverbs 31:12 - you will do your husband only good and not evil all the days of your life. The fruit of that will be that your husband's heart will safely trust you, and he will rise up and praise you.